



Figure 1: The install configuration page



Figure 2: The file browser

Basically, ownCloud supports MySQL or SQLite as the back-end database, so keep that in mind while installing the packages and database. Now that all dependencies are in place, we can download ownCloud from the site (see Links [1]) or from its Git repository; extract it, copy it to Apache's Web root directory, and set the permissions, as follows:

```
tar xvfz owncloud-master.tar.gz
sudo cp -r owncloud /var/www
cd /var/www
sudo chown -R www-data : www-data owncloud
```

Assuming you have Apache properly configured, you can go to the deployed location via a browser, like <http://localhost/owncloud>. You will be asked (Figure 1) to set up your admin username and password, and you're done! However, if you're using MySQL for the database, you will also need to enter those details (database username, password etc). You might also want to change the default data storage directory.

Alternatively, if you want to upgrade from ownCloud version 2 to 3, you simply have to replace all files, except the custom configuration and your data. As for version 1, unfortunately there is no way to upgrade from it, and you will have to do a fresh installation from scratch.

A walk-through

The Web interface (Figure 2) is rather simple, with a list of files in the centre, and tabs to various applications like the file browser, music player, calendar, contacts, gallery, etc, at the left. At the



Figure 3: The music player



Figure 4: The contacts application

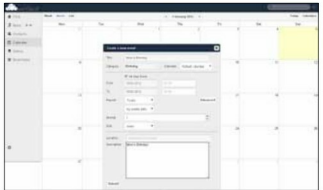


Figure 5: The calendar application

bottom left corner is the *Settings* button, which reveals further options when clicked (Figure 7). Clicking each file either allows you to download it, or opens it in the text editor if it is a simple text file. There are also various sharing options, allowing you to share files among users and user groups. The text editor (Figure 8) is quite well developed, and has features like syntax highlighting and code folding. We can even read PDFs with the help of the integrated PDF viewer, which does not require any plug-ins to be installed on the client system (thanks to *pdf.js*). The music player (Figure 3) allows you to stream music that has been uploaded to the ownCloud server. It can play MP3 files, and show you basic tag information stored in the ID3 tags—no fancy features here. The calendar and contacts applications (Figures 4 and 5) are very impressive, with both providing calDAV and cardDAV synchronisation for applications like Thunderbird, Evolution, etc. The calendar application also allows for recurring events and all-day events like birthdays, etc. You can set up multiple calendars and address books, with each having their own calDAV/cardDAV link, so that these can be synchronised independently.

The latest feature in ownCloud 3 is the photo gallery application (Figure 6), which includes automatic album creation and album covers. The photo viewer, too, is very beautiful and simple. An annoying feature, though, is that an album and thumbnails in the gallery remain there even if the associated files have been deleted from the server. There is also an option to install third-party applications from the